

The President with the Joint Chiefs of Staff and senior defence officials (left to right): General David Shoup, commandant of the marine corps; General Earle Wheeler chief of staff of the army; Admiral George Anderson, chief of naval operations; Secretary of Defense, Robert McNamara; President Kennedy; General Maxwell Taylor, Chairman of the Joint Chiefs; Deputy Secretary of Defense, Roswell Gilpatric; General Curtis LeMay, chief of staff of the air force. The Joint Chiefs opposed both a blockade and a surgical strike on the missiles. Instead, they argued for extensive aerial bombardment followed by an invasion of Cuba. *(Public domain)*